

do a good job but the Pixel 7 can sometimes be soft on details – so the intricacies on a face or the subject's clothes may get clipped out. We also tried flash for low light images, and the iPhone 14 surprisingly had the most overexposed shot here which made the subject look ghostly white.

As for low light photography using the ultrawide camera, the shots are the brightest on the Pixel 7. The iPhone 14 delivered some underexposed images where the details in the shadows were visibly muted. Both the Pixel and Samsung's low light ultrawide performance is flagship level.

Selfie

The Samsung Galaxy S23 and the iPhone 14 have extremely capable selfie shooters. While the Pixel 7's selfie camera also clicks decent images, the detail retention isn't as impressive as the other two. For example, in the images shown here, the texture of the cap's cloth is missing on the Pixel 7's photo. Dynamic range, on the other

three phones didn't match our expectations. We expected more crisp low light selfie shots from all three of these flagship camera phones.

Videos

The Pixel 7 and iPhone 14 shoot at a maximum of 4K at 60 fps but on the Samsung Galaxy S23, you can shoot videos up to 8K at 30 fps, which is an improvement over last year's 8K at 24 fps. 8K video is surprisingly good in daylight on the S23. The colours are nice and vibrant, and the dynamic range is quite impressive as well. Detail is also pretty good, slightly like upscaled 4K content. Now, circling back to 4K footage, this looks decent enough on all three camera, but in tricky lighting, the S23 can look a bit noisier than the Pixel and iPhone footage.

We also tested Action/Active/Ultra Steady Mode on all three cameras and both the iPhone 14 and Samsung Galaxy S23 impressed us with how steady the footage looks. It almost mimics a gimbal, which is fantastic.

focus, all three phones are lightning fast at focusing, so no complaints there. Selfie videos are great on all three phones in daylight, there's very little separating the three, but in low light, Samsung just decimates the competition here by pulling in much more light.

Moving on to low light videography with the primary camera, yet again, the Samsung Galaxy S23 has the brightest and most detailed footage. iPhone misses out on some detail in the shadow areas and the Pixel 7's video is almost unusable since it is rife with grain and noise. In terms of colour and detail, the Samsung Galaxy S23 is the clear winner at shooting low light video.

Verdict

The question we set out to answer was which compact flagship smartphone in 2023 has the best and the most consistent camera system. After going through hundreds of cameras samples, and dozens of video samples, we think we've nailed down the answer. While these three phones are some of the best compact camera smartphones in the market right now, in terms of consistently, the Pixel 7 has been the least consistent due to subpar low light selfies and videography. The iPhone 14, on the other hand, is more than capable of shooting consistently good-looking daylight images and videos, however, there are some serious issues such as the occasional blue tint and loss of detail in low light images. The Samsung Galaxy S23 does have a tendency to whitewash human subjects, but overall, in most other tests, there were only minor issues. It remained the most consistent photo and video shooter in most of our tests. Be it portrait shots with great edge detection, the bonus of a telephoto lens, or a fantastic ultrawide camera, the S23's photography and videography chops impressed us. However, if you are looking for the most bang for your buck, the Pixel 7 may still be your best choice, especially if you don't shoot a lot of videos in low light. **d**



iPhone 14 (left), Pixel 7 (middle), Galaxy S23 (right)

hand, is excellent on all three phones but colours are, once again, the most true-to-life on the Pixel 7. Don't write the Samsung and iPhone off though since their selfies look vibrant and social-media-ready from the get-go.

All three phones also allow users to click wide-angle selfies but the Pixel 7 has the widest frame, so you can fit more friends into the shot at a time. Low light selfies are the best on the Samsung Galaxy S23, but honestly, all

Samsung's footage is more detailed though since it shoots Ultra Steady in 4K while the iPhone 14 shoots Action Mode in 2.8K. The Pixel 7 isn't really in this race, since its footage is a lot shakier than the other two phones even with Active Mode turned on.

The iPhone definitely still has the lead in one area – shutter response. The phone can quick multiple photos in quick succession with no lag, unlike the Samsung and Pixel. As for auto